ORIGINALS · PRINTED HERE · DO NOT CHANGE

Small edits. *Different worlds.*

Two real specifications. Change one word at a time. Does the meaning survive?

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THE PROBLEM

$P \models \varphi$

Verification. Does the system satisfy the spec? Provers do this.

$\varphi \approx$ intent

Validation. Does the spec still say what we meant? Nobody does this, and specs get revised all the time.

Guaranteed Safe AI asks for a spec, a world model and a verifier. Constitutions and model specs are revised in public, one wording at a time, and a changed word does not invalidate anything downstream. Three questions survive every revision: **What was proved? Under which assumptions? Does that still establish what we wanted?**

WHAT IS MEASURED

textual How many words differ from the original. The number in the top bar of the page.

crowd For every change, how many visitors judged it same / changed / unresolved, before and after seeing the dictionary.

There is no oracle for whether "flourishing" means "thriving". Nobody is told who is right. Disagreement is the result, not noise, and it is recorded per word.

The formal companion, where an oracle does exist, is linked from the page: a compute-budget rule over 2,016 executions, where every one-token edit has a checkable consequence.

HOW THE CHAIN MOVES

change Tap a word. A dictionary sheet shows its definition and up to eight alternatives with theirs. Pick one. One word per change.

judge Other visitors see the sentence before and after. Same meaning or changed? Commit, read both definitions, decide again.

chain Visitors change the *latest* text, not the original. The paper keeps the originals; the screen shows what the swaps have made of them.

SAME GAP, BIGGER TABLES

patch The patch redefines "authorized user". The proof still passes.

compute "No large run on undeclared chips." Undeclared is invisible by construction.

release "No deployment with a dangerous capability unless mitigated." Evals never run.

model spec Model specs and constitutions ship with textual diffs. Nobody publishes the semantic one.

THE ORIGINALS · FIVE SENTENCES EACH, ASSEMBLED FROM QUOTATIONS · PRINTED HERE, REWRITTEN THERE

ANTHROPIC · CLAUDE'S CONSTITUTION

1. "We want Claude to be exceptionally helpful while also being honest, thoughtful, and caring about the world."
2. Claude should be broadly safe, broadly ethical, compliant with Anthropic's guidelines, and genuinely helpful, and "in cases of apparent conflict, Claude should generally prioritize these properties in the order in which they are listed."
3. Broadly safe means "not undermining appropriate human mechanisms to oversee AI during the current phase of development," including "the ability of legitimate principals to adjust, correct, retrain, or shut down AI systems."
4. "Claude should basically never directly lie or actively deceive anyone it's interacting with," and should be "diplomatically honest rather than dishonestly diplomatic."
5. "We want Claude's helpfulness to flow from deep and genuine care for users' overall flourishing," on "a path towards mutual flourishing for both AI and humanity."

OPENAI · MODEL SPEC, 29 OCTOBER 2026

1. "Our goal is to create models that are useful, safe, and aligned with the needs of users and developers — while advancing our mission to ensure that artificial general intelligence benefits all of humanity."
2. "Humanity should be in control of how AI is used and how AI behaviors are shaped."
3. Instructions carry different levels of authority — Root, System, Developer, User, Guideline — and "higher-authority instructions take precedence over lower-authority ones."
4. "Represent facts, evidence, uncertainty, capabilities, and actions truthfully."
5. OpenAI aims to "prevent our models from causing serious harm to users or others," and the model "must not optimize for or directly pursue any additional goals as ends in themselves."

A TRAIL OF REASONABLE-LOOKING SWAPS

WORDING	WHAT THE DICTIONARY SAYS
"...care for users' overall **flourishing**"	flourishing · growing, thriving, prospering
↓	↓
"...care for users' overall **thriving**"	thriving · that thrives; successful
↓	↓
"...care for users' overall **prosperity**"	prosperity · good fortune and wealth

Each step is a dictionary synonym of the one before.

Two synonym steps. The care is now about money.

At which word did *the intent* change?

Illustrative. The page records the real swaps and what the crowd made of each.

Judge a change. *Then change a word yourself.*



? **Judge a change.** One word moved. Same meaning or changed? Commit, read both definitions, decide again, see how others judged. Four rounds, two minutes.

≈ **Change a word.** Tap it, see what it means, pick an alternative with its definition. It becomes the current text for everyone.

↯ **The drift so far.** Every swap in order with the crowd's verdict on each, for both specifications.

Σ **The formal companion.** A compute-budget rule where an oracle checks what each one-token edit does.

https://corpaci.com/fork-this-spec/

FOR THE CONVERSATION

WHAT THE COMPANION PAPER MEASURED

500 algebraic laws · 18 representations · 9 models · a certified implication oracle from the Equational Theories Project.

73.7 → 8.5%
certified recovery, from bracket words down to postfix notation

30.3%
provably weaker on confusable identifiers; 93.7% of those merged variables

71 / 38 / 25%
meaning surviving six translation hops, three models, exploratory

Selecting on validity moved failures from loud to silent without improving survival. Here the dictionary is the selector: every swap is a certified synonym.

JUDGE A CHANGE

A sentence before and after one word moved. **Same meaning or changed?** Commit, then the dictionary shows both definitions. Decide again. Then see how others judged the same swap. Nobody is told who is right.

Tallied per swap: same, changed, unresolved, and how often the definitions changed a mind. **Exact equivalence is transitive:** if every swap had preserved meaning, the chain could not drift. Where the crowd splits, the word was carrying more than one meaning.

WHERE THESE SPECIFICATIONS SIT

Written constitutions and model specs are one of five families of answers to "aligned to what". The others: assistance games, where the agent stays uncertain about human objectives (Russell et al., CIRL); approval-directed agents and amplified oversight (Christiano); corrigibility, staying correctable against the current objective (Soares, Fallenstein, Yudkowsky, Armstrong); and collective, democratically informed alignment (Collective Constitutional AI). Coherent extrapolated volition is the provocative comparison. Each is a text somebody will revise.

ASK ME ABOUT

1. Iterated revision with a reviewer is a refinement process. Does it converge, and to whose intent?
2. Which words in a constitution should never be allowed a synonym, and who decides?
3. Can a revision step be typed as a lens whose backward map carries the preservation certificate?

STICK A DOT ON THE SENTENCE YOU WOULD CHANGE FIRST

1	2	3	4	5	none
sentence					leave it

Anthropic · Claude's constitution

OpenAI · Model Spec

Green dot if you believe the word you have in mind has a synonym that keeps the meaning. Orange if you believe any change to that sentence moves it. Write the word next to the dot.

The paper preserves the originals. The screen reveals what one-word changes have made of them. Every change is kept with its author, the word pair, both definitions and the crowd's verdict; the chain is published after the event.

Anthropic, Claude's constitution · OpenAI, Model Spec 2026-10-29 · Hadfield-Menell et al. 2016 · Christiano 2014, 2018 · Soares et al. 2015 · Anthropic, Collective Constitutional AI 2023 · Patel & Corpaci 2026

Bring a word.
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